



Commonly confused words

Choose the most suitable word in the pairs below

1. **Advice and advise:** "Advice" is a noun and is a suggestion; "advise" is a verb and is the act of giving that suggestion.

I ----- all of my clients to get more sleep; most of them take this -----.

2. **Affect and effect:** "Affect" is a verb that refers to the influence that something has on something else; "effect" is a noun that refers to a result.

Did Vitamin C ----- the patients? I am curious if it had any -----.

3. **Among and between:** "Between" is reserved for two items; "among" is used for three or more.

It was easy to choose ----- the peach cobbler and the apple crisp;
however, it was difficult to decide ----- the brownie, ice cream, and custard.

4. **Any body, anybody, any one, and anyone:** "Any body" and "any one" are adjectives modifying a noun. Example: I like to swim in any body of water. I could not single out any one person. "Anybody" and "anyone" are pronouns.

He would go to prom with ----- . ----- would do!



5. **Casual and causal:** "Casual" refers to something that is informal or unplanned. "Causal" refers to the cause of something or to something that makes things happen.

They wore -----l clothes for the party. The ----- factor in the students' declining energy was the absence of lunch.

6. **Consequently and subsequently:** "Consequently" suggests causation; "subsequently" refers to something that happens later and is not caused by the previously mentioned action.

Vera lost her dog, and Doug ----- lost his cat. -----, they met each other at the Humane Society.

7. **Every day and everyday:** "Every day" is an adjective and a noun; "everyday" is just an adjective asserting that something is commonplace.

I brush my teeth -----; it is part of my ----- hygiene routine.

8. **Every one and everyone:** "Every one" is an adjective and a pronoun; "everyone" is a pronoun.

I counted ----- . This seemed to satisfy everyone at the party.

9. **Farther and further:** "Farther" refers to a physical distance; "further" refers to time.



Until ----- notice, you are not allowed to go any -----.

10. **Fewer and less:** "Fewer" should be used with things that can be counted; "less" should be used for amounts you cannot count.

----- boys than girls were upset; however, the girls were ----- upset than anticipated.

11. **Infer and imply:** "Infer" means to deduce something and is what readers do. "Imply" means to hint or suggest, and it is what writers do.

She described a red, octagonal sign in the parking lot. I ----- it was a stop sign.

The teacher -----that there might be a quiz tomorrow.

12. **Its and it's:** "Its" is the possessive form of "it"; "it's" is a contraction meaning "it is."

The baby saw the dog and grabbed ----- tail. ----- interesting that she would do that.

13. **May be and maybe:** "May be" is a verb phrase; "maybe" is an adverb.

Obi wan Kenobi ----- our last hope, or ----- someone else will succeed.



14. **Precede and proceed:** "Precede" suggests that something comes before; proceed is an invitation to continue.

According to league rules, the game could not -----d unless "Take Me Out to the Ball Game" ----- the bottom of the sixth inning.

15. **Principal and principle:** As a noun, "principal" refers to an individual; as an adjective, it suggests that something is significant. "Principle" suggests that something is grounded in theory.

The ----- insisted that the ----- component of the school's success was its teachers. The ----- insisted that the teachers taught Darwinian -----.

Teacher's Key

1. I advise all of my clients to get more sleep; most of them take this advice.
2. Did Vitamin C affect the patients? I am curious if it had any effect.
3. It was easy to choose between the peach cobbler and the apple crisp; however, it was difficult to decide among the brownie, ice cream, and custard.
4. He would go to prom with anyone. Anybody would do!
5. The causal factor in the students' declining energy was the absence of lunch.



6. Vera lost her dog, and Doug subsequently lost his cat. Consequently, they met each other at the Humane Society.
7. I brush my teeth every day; it is part of my everyday hygiene routine.
8. I counted every one. This seemed to satisfy everyone at the party.
9. Until further notice, you are not allowed to go any farther.
10. Fewer boys than girls were upset; however, the girls were less upset than anticipated.
11. She described a red, octagonal sign in the parking lot. I inferred it was a stop sign. The teacher implied that there might be pop quiz tomorrow.
12. The baby saw the dog and grabbed its tail. It's interesting that she would do that.
13. Obi wan Kenobi may be our last hope, or maybe someone else will save us.
14. The principal insisted that the principal component of the school's success was its teachers. The principal insisted that the teachers taught Darwinian principles.